

THE AUSTRALIAN DEMENTIA SUMMIT

Sydney

Tuesday 11th November – Wednesday 12th November



Advisory Scientific Committee:

Dr. Henry Brodaty, Scientia Professor of Ageing and Mental Health & Co-Director of the
Centre for Healthy Brain Ageing, **University of New South Wales**

Dr. Paul Yates, Clinical Associate Professor, **University of Melbourne**

Dr. Elie Matar, Consultant Neurologist & Sleep Physician, **University of Sydney**

Confirmed Speakers

1. **Professor John O'Brien**, Head of Old Age Psychiatry Research Group & Honorary Consultant, **University of Cambridge**
2. **Dr. Perminder Sachdev**, Professor of Neuropsychiatry, **UNSW**
3. **Dr. Henry Brodaty**, Scientia Professor of Ageing and Mental Health & Co-Director of the Centre for Healthy Brain Ageing, **University of New South Wales**
4. **Dr. Paul Yates**, Clinical Associate Professor, **University of Melbourne**
5. **Dr. Elie Matar**, Consultant Neurologist & Sleep Physician, **University of Sydney**
6. **Dr. Helen Macpherson**, Senior Research Fellow School of Exercise and Nutrition Sciences, **Deakin University**
7. **Dr. Adam Vogel**, Centre for Neuroscience of Speech, **The University of Melbourne**
8. **Dr Eddy Roccati**, Wicking Dementia Research and Education Centre Research Fellow, **University of Tasmania**
9. **Dr. Kaarin Anstey**, Senior Principal Research Scientist, **NEURA**
10. **Dr. Nicola Lautenschlager**, Deputy Dean, People, Community & Partnerships, **University of Melbourne**
11. **Dr. Claire Shepherd**, Director, **Sydney Brain Bank**
12. **Dr. Wei Qi Koh**, Lecturer in Occupational Therapy, The University of Queensland.
13. **Dr. Craig Sinclair**, Senior Research Fellow in the School of Psychology, **The University of New South Wales**
14. **Dr Stephanie Harrison**, Associate Professor of Health Services and Epidemiology, **Flinders University**
15. **Dr Azadeh Feizpour**, Senior Research Fellow, **The Florey**
16. **Dr. Peter W. Schofield**, Conjoint Professor School of Medicine and Public Health, **University of Newcastle and Hunter New England LHD**
17. **Benjamin Goudey**, Technical Lead, **Australia Biocommons**
18. **Professor Jacqueline Close AM**, Orthogeriatrics Consultant, **Prince of Wales Hospital**
19. **Dr. Lee-Fay Low**, Professor in Ageing and Health, **The University of Sydney**
20. **Andrew Teodorczuk**, Professor, **Faculty of Health, The University of Queensland**
21. **Dr Emma Devenney**, Neurologist & NHMRC early career fellow, **NeuRA**
22. **A/Professor Michelle Lupton**, *Senior Research Officer*, **QIMR Berghofer Medical Research Institute**
23. **A/Prof Raymond Schwartz**, Neurologist, **Southern Neurology**
24. **Professor Mathew Summers**, Discipline Lead, Psychology, **The University of the Sunshine Coast**

DAY ONE - TUESDAY, 11th NOVEMBER 2025

8:00 Registration

8:45 Welcome to Country

9:00 Introduction and Overview

Chairperson: **Dr. Henry Brodaty**, Scientia Professor of Ageing and Mental Health & Co-Director of the Centre for Healthy Brain Ageing, **University of New South Wales**

Insights on the Modern Landscape of Dementia

9:10 International keynote: Lewy body dementia - an update on our understanding

- Gain insight into the latest research on Lewy body dementia, and how this can directly lead to improved clinical care
- Understanding how its distinct clinical features can be assessed in clinical practice and how it differs from other neurodegenerative conditions
- Explore best practices for diagnosis and management, focusing on the management of key symptoms to optimise quality of life through tailored care approaches.

Professor John O'Brien, Head of Old Age Psychiatry Research Group & Honorary Consultant, **University of Cambridge**

9:40 Panel: Success Factors for Interdisciplinary Collaboration in Dementia Care

- Care encompasses medical management, psychosocial support, and assistance with daily activities, requiring coordinated efforts among healthcare providers, caregivers, and community resources
- Navigate the interplay of cognitive, and behavioural symptoms, fostering collaboration between neurology, psychiatry, and general practice.
- Practical strategies for adapting assessment tools for diverse communities and overcoming stigmas for person centered care.

Chair: Dr. Henry Brodaty, Scientia Professor of Ageing and Mental Health & Co-Director of the Centre for Healthy Brain Ageing, **University of New South Wales**

Dr. Perminder Sachdev, Professor of Neuropsychiatry, **UNSW**

Dr. Lee-Fay Low, Professor in Ageing and Health, **The University of Sydney**

10:30 Morning tea & coffee

Decoding the Diagnosis: Advanced Tools and Early Clues

11:00 Understanding Associations in the Genetics of Neurodegeneration for Tailored Approaches

- Discover how genetic insights are paving the way for personalised treatments tailored to an individual's genetic profile, improving therapeutic outcomes.
- Neurophysiological approaches to biomarkers in dementia

A/Professor Michelle Lupton, Senior Research Officer, **QIMR Berghofer Medical Research Institute**

11:30 Practical Therapeutics, Biomarkers and Diagnostics

- Update on biomarkers of neurodegeneration in frontotemporal dementia and the potential of specific protein markers to enable more precise, pathology-specific diagnoses
- Utility of these biomarkers in distinguishing FTD from other neurodegenerative and psychiatric conditions.

Dr Emma Devenney, Neurologist & NHMRC early career fellow, **NeuRA**

12:00 Clues for Neurodegeneration Through Speech Pathologies

- Techniques to detect subtle changes in speech, such as reduced complexity and slower speech rate, which may serve as early indicators of cognitive decline
- Effective and accessible supplementing traditional neuropsychological tests and aiding in the diagnosis of complex dementia presentations.

Dr. Adam Vogel, Centre for Neuroscience of Speech, **The University of Melbourne**

12:30 Understanding Dementia Resilience in Clinical Management and Early Detection

- Learn about individuals that exhibit cognitive resilience and factors contributing to this resilience highlighting the importance of lifelong cognitive stimulation.
- learn how screening tools can detect the earliest signs of cognitive change.
- Apply these concepts to manage complex clinical cases, including those with comorbidities like Traumatic Brain Injury, to better inform patient prognosis and care.

Dr. Peter W. Schofield, Conjoint Professor School of Medicine and Public Health, **University of Newcastle and Hunter New England LHD**

1:00 Lunch

The Prevention Imperative & Personalised Strategies for Primary Care

1:50 Panel: Onset Prevention and Treatment Strategies; Diagnosis and Staging of Alzheimer's Disease

- The adoption of fluid biomarker testing in primary care could improve early diagnosis and staging of Alzheimer's, but practical barriers such as accessibility, cost, and protocol standardisation remain.
- Understand the logistical and clinical considerations for implementing biomarker testing.
- What current and emerging strategies are working for prevention, diagnosis, and staging in primary care.

Chair: Dr. Elie Matar, Consultant Neurologist & Sleep Physician, **University of Sydney**

Dr Eddy Roccati, Wicking Dementia Research and Education Centre Research Fellow, **University of Tasmania**,

Dr. Kaarin Anstey, Senior Principal Research Scientist, **NEURA**,

Dr. Nicola Lautenschlage, Deputy Dean, People, Community & Partnerships, **University of Melbourne**

2:40 Healthy Living for Healthy Brain Ageing

- Examine the role of chronic stress and disruptions in the gut microbiome as contributing factors in dementia, opening new avenues for prevention and intervention strategies.
- Appreciate how stress and mitochondrial dysfunction impact neurodegeneration and tau pathology
- Learn practical strategies for implementing lifestyle and dietary interventions to potentially prevent or slow cognitive decline in individuals at risk.

Dr. Helen Macpherson, Senior Research Fellow School of Exercise and Nutrition Sciences, **Deakin University**

3:15 Afternoon tea

3:45 Exercise and Gendered Differences in Biomarkers and Pathophysiology

- Disproportionate affliction of Alzheimer's in women, highlighting differences observed in biomarker profiles and disease progression. However, risk factors for Dementia with Lewy bodies still strongest with men
- How to Identify differences and communicate therapeutic approaches ensuring that both men and women receive effective and personalized care for Dementia and its sub-types.

4:15 Managing the Emotional Landscape of BPSD and Tackling Overmedication

- Delve into evidence-based, non-pharmacological interventions, such as cognitive training and mindfulness, and their demonstrated impact on improving mood, self-esteem, and social engagement

- Review the critical role of early and comprehensive neuropsychological assessment in developing effective management strategies that can enhance the quality of life for both the individual with dementia and their caregivers

Professor Mathew Summers, Discipline Lead, Psychology, **The University of the Sunshine Coast**

4:45 Acknowledgements and Closing Statements

5:00 Networking drinks

DAY TWO - WEDNESDAY, 12th NOVEMBER 2025

8:20 Registration

8:45 Welcome to Country

9:10 Opening Address and Introduction

Chairperson: Dr. Elie Matar, Consultant Neurologist & Sleep Physician, **University of Sydney**

Integrating Therapies, Technology, and Complex Neuropathologies

9:20 Fireside Chat: Assessing the Promise and Practicality of Donanemab & Disease-Modifying Dementia Therapies in Australia

- Disease-modifying therapies such as Donanemab offer new options for slowing Alzheimer's progression, but their use requires significant changes to clinical infrastructure and workforce capability in Australia.
- Gain clarity on the real-world effectiveness and limitations of Donanemab.
- Identify practical steps for preparing clinical settings for the integration of new dementia therapies.

A/Prof Raymond Schwartz, Neurologist, **Southern Neurology**, **Dr. Paul Yates**, Clinical Associate Professor, **University of Melbourne**

10:00 Complex neuropathology of aging: co-pathologies and their clinical implications.

- Explore recent advances in our understanding of the complex and often overlapping neuropathologies that occur during aging. Drawing on new insights from the Sydney Brain Bank
- This session will examine key neuropathological and cellular changes that occur during ageing, and their clinicopathological correlations.

Dr. Claire Shepherd, Director, **Sydney Brain Bank**

10:30 Morning tea & coffee

11:00 AI & Data Analytics in Dementia

- Explore how predictive analytics and artificial intelligence (AI) are transforming dementia care, enabling earlier detection and more personalised treatment through the analysis of clinical and imaging data.
- How AI tools are already being used to forecast dementia progression and tailor interventions to individual patient needs, enhancing care outcomes.

- Learn how the integration of imaging data with AI is improving early identification of cognitive decline, allowing for proactive interventions and better management strategies.

Benjamin Goudey, Technical Lead, **Australia Biocommons**

11:30 Improving the Therapeutic Potential of Digital Tools for Alzheimer's Disease

- Explore how digital tools can be integrated into comprehensive care programs to continuously monitor symptoms and adjust treatment plans for individuals with Alzheimer's disease.
- Ethical strategies for using digital health solutions to support real-time symptom tracking, improving care coordination and outcomes for individuals with complex needs.

Wei Qi Koh, Lecturer in Occupational Therapy, **The University of Queensland**.

12:00 Challenges to Overcome in Prevention, Diagnosis and Management for Delirium & Dementia

- Delirium frequently is associated with long-term adverse outcomes, including an eightfold increased risk of subsequent dementia.
- The best practices for spotting, stopping and treating delirium and provide guidance on common challenging clinical dilemmas

Andrew Teodorczuk, Professor, **Faculty of Health, The University of Queensland**

12:30 Lunch

Managing Clinical Considerations from Frailty to Support Partners

1:30 Frailty Comorbidities in Neurodegenerative Disease

- Recognizing frailty in older adults is essential, as it is associated with increased vulnerability to adverse health outcomes, including cognitive decline and hospitalization.
- Comprehensive Geriatric Assessments (CGA) enabling individualized care plans that address medical, psychological, and functional aspects
- Addressing comorbidities through multidisciplinary teams ensures comprehensive care, optimizing treatment strategies and improving patient outcomes.

Professor Jacqueline Close AM, Orthogeriatrics Consultant, **Prince of Wales Hospital**

2:00 Assessing Mild Cognitive Impairment and Decision Making for Early Intervention

- Identify key tools and frameworks for assessing decision-making abilities.
- Discuss ethical dilemmas and legal considerations in capacity assessments.
- Interdisciplinary approach to supporting clinicians in making informed decisions.

Dr. Craig Sinclair, Senior Research Fellow in the School of Psychology, **the University of New South Wales**

2:30 Review of Care Partners Support and Clinical Innovation

- Learn practical approaches for supporting carers, including access to education, respite, and emotional support to reduce burnout and improve outcomes for all.

3:00 Afternoon Tea

Blood, The Brain & The Pathways to Understanding

3:30 Lightning Rounds: Blood, The Brain & The Pathways to Understanding

- The adoption of blood-based biomarkers, such as p-tau and A β ratios, into routine assessments is transforming AD diagnosis, enabling earlier detection and intervention.
- Consideration of factors such as test accessibility, cost, and the need for standardized protocols are needed to ensure accurate interpretation and application.

*These short talks will catch you up to speed on all the pathological context required for best practice care for Alzheimer's and dementia sub-types

3:40 Round 1:	Comorbidity of cerebrovascular and Alzheimer's disease Dr Stephanie Harrison , Associate Professor of Health Services and Epidemiology, Flinders University
4:00 Round 2:	Amyloid-beta toxicity and interactions with tau pathology Invited: Professor, Ralph Martins Professor, Macquarie Medical School
4:20 Round 3:	Imaging-based biomarkers Dr Azadeh Feizpour , Senior Research Fellow, The Florey
4:40 Round 4:	Vascular dementia and stroke

Chair: Dr. Paul Yates, Clinical Associate Professor, **University of Melbourne**

5:05 Closing Acknowledgements

5:10 Closing of Conference